Basics

01 circles and turns

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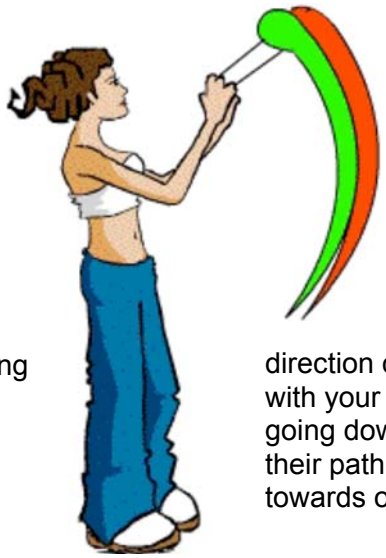
Lesson 1
Basics: Circles and Turns (page 1 of 1)

Forward Circles

Ok, try spinning some small circles, making sure that the poi are parallel to each other, swinging to either side of you.

You should only use your wrists and fingers for this - simply scooping the poi up to the top of their circles and letting them drop down to the bottom.

Backward Circles



Now try to spin some backwards circles. Keep doing this until you feel comfortable with both arms. Try to keep the planes as flat as possible –

You can guide the direction of the poi by pointing with your fingers as the poi are going down. This will correct their path if they're slanting towards or away from you.

Turning With Circles

1.

Start by spinning some forward circles.

2.

Step 90º to the side as the poi travel down - pulling both poi past your legs.

3.

Continue to turn a further 90º until you're facing the opposite direction.

4.

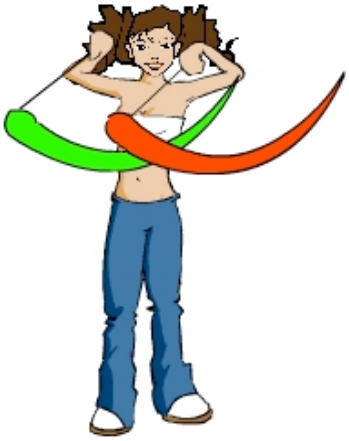
Woo Hoo!! You should now have turned 180º degrees and be spinning backward circles.

Lesson 2
Basics: Shoulder Reels (page 1 of 2)

Shoulder Reels

With reels the poi are spinning parallel circles either infront of you or behind you. This can be quite tricky at first as your left hand will be spinning 'outward' circles and your right will be spinning 'inward' circles. Your hands will be doing different things at the same time so don't worry if you find this confusing to start with, just follow the step by step guide and remember to take it slowly.

1.



Start by spinning the poi in front of you in a circular motion, keeping the poi parallel to each other.

2.

As the poi reaches the top of the circle twist your wrist so your palms are facing upwards with your fingers pointing behind you. This allows the poi to pull diagonally behind you and over your head.

3.

With the momentum let both poi follow their path behind your head.

Turn over for stages 4 and 5…

Lesson 2
Basics: Shoulder Reels (page 2 of 2)

4.

Direct the poi as they are coming down by pointing to where you want them to go.

5.

As the poi come up, start to turn your hands so the palms are facing down (back to how you started), and gently pull the poi back over your head so that they are infront of you again.

Shoulder Reels

Phew! Remember that it's difficult to picture what the poi are doing when they are behind your head. It helps if you practice in front of a mirror or window.

Also, you should try to keep your elbows up at shoulder height, hands on either side of your head. This is important as it helps to stop the poi getting tangled up - especially when they're behind your head.

Lesson 3
Basics: Hip Reels (page 1 of 2)

Hip Reels

Like the shoulder reels the poi are both moving in a circular motion in front of you and then behind, with the left hand spinning 'outward' circles and the right spinning 'inward' circles.

It's important to remember that your hands don't make the same movements as in shoulder reels so again follow this simple guide, and if it helps you can practise with one hand at a time to get used to the movement.

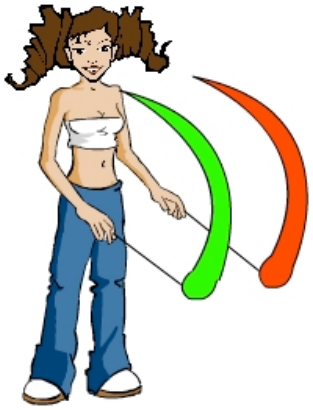
1.

Start the move with the poi on opposite sides of you with your palms facing down

2.

As the poi reaches the top of the circle twist your wrist so your palms are facing upwards with your fingers pointing behind you. This allows the poi to pull diagonally behind you and over your head.

3.



With the momentum let both poi follow their path behind your head.

Turn over for stages 4 to 6…

Lesson 3
Basics: Hip Reels (page 2 of 2)

4.

Start the move with the poi on opposite sides of you with your palms facing down

5.

As the poi reaches the top of the circle twist your wrist so your palms are facing upwards with your fingers pointing behind you. This allows the poi to pull diagonally behind you and over your head.

6.

With the momentum let both poi follow their path behind your head.

Lesson 4
Basics: The Weave (page 1 of 3)

The Three-Beat Weave

Ok, so you've learnt basic turns and have just mastered some simple reels. Next up is the 3 beat weave - So called because the poi spin 3 circles (or beats) around you - One beat on the near side of your body and a further two on the far side of you.

The easiest way for you to learn this trick is by using just one hand so that you can get used to the movement and rhythm of the trick.

One Handed Version

1.

Start by spinning some forwards circles with just one poi.

2.

Cross the poi over your empty hand to the other side of your body and spin another forward circle...

3.

...When it reaches the top of its circle bring it back over your empty hand...

Turn over for stages 4 and 5…

Lesson 4
Basics: The Weave (page 2 of 3)

…One Handed Version Continued.

4.

...As it travels down cross the poi under your empty hand and spin another forward circle.

5.

Finally when the poi starts to come down you should bring it back over to the starting position.

Two Handed Version

1.

Again it's easiest to start with just one hand so like before spin a forward circle.

2.

Use the same principle as before - as the poi goes down you want to cross it to the other side of your body.

3.

This is where the fun starts! As your left poi reaches the top of the circle your aim is to chase it with the right poi.

Lesson 4
Basics: The Weave (page 3 of 3)

…Two Handed Version Continued.

4.

Let the right poi spin a circle and as it goes down on your left the left poi should be finishing its circle on the right.

5.

Then as the left poi goes down on the right, the right poi should be coming up on the left...

6.

With the poi still chasing each other continue with this motion. Once again it helps to be looking in a mirror or window, as it's not un-common for your weaker hand to be missing a circle.

Don't worry if you don't crack it straight away. Just be patient and go back to just one hand if it helps.

When you're comfortable doing the weave you should start to think about perfecting it by practising with your wrists together. This makes it look like a single wheel spinning around you.

Lesson 5
Basics: The Butterfly (page 1 of 2)

The Butterfly

Here's a little beauty for you all! The butterfly involves spinning parrallel circles in front of you. The poi spin in different directions giving the impression that only one circle is being drawn.

In this lesson we'll be showing you using 'inward' circles.

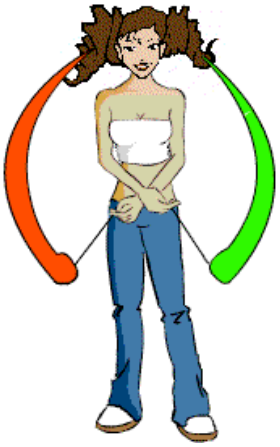
1.

Ok. Start off by spinning some inward circles.

2.

Move your hands in, keeping one higher than the other (in most cases your dominant hand will go higher).

3.



Bring your hands in closer until one is exactly above the other.

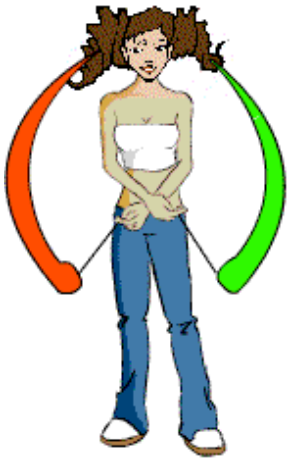
Turn over for stage 4…

Lesson 5
Basics: The Butterfly (page 2 of 2)

4.

Use the same principle as before - as the poi goes down you want to cross it to the other side of your body.

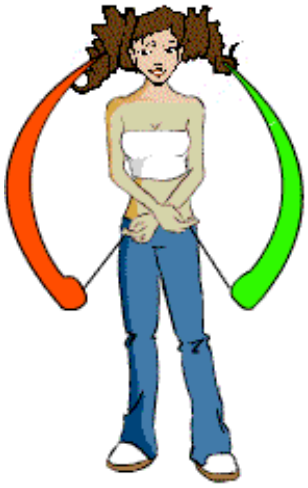
Lesson 6
Basics: Angel Wings (page 1 of 2)



Angel Wings

Now you're comfortable with the butterfly its time to take it to the next step. Angel Wings or Overhead Butterfly as some refer to it involves an inward butterfly in front of you and then behind your head. If you're confident with the butterfly you should find this trick fairly simple - All you need to do is follow the beat of the poi and go with the flow!

1.



The obvious starting point for this move is by doing some inward butterfly. Do this for a while until you get into a good rhythm.

2.

When the poi come up lift your arms over your head letting them fall behind you.

3.

You don't need to move your wrists or fingers at this point just follow the rhythm and let your hands bounce behind you.

Turn over for stage 4…

Lesson 6
Basics: Angel Wings (page 2 of 2)

4.

As they bounce back up lift them over your head again and continue with inward butterfly.

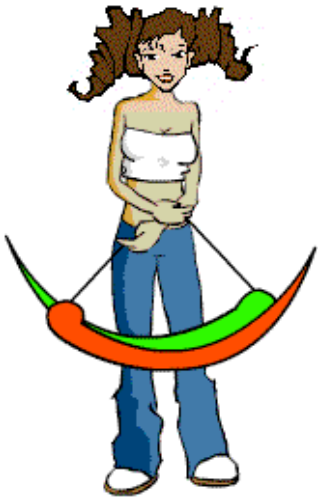
Lesson 7
Basics: Butterfly Turn (page 1 of 2)

Butterfly Turn

So You're eager to start turning with the butterfly eh?

For this move you're going to have to be comfortable doing both inward and outward butterfly.

1.

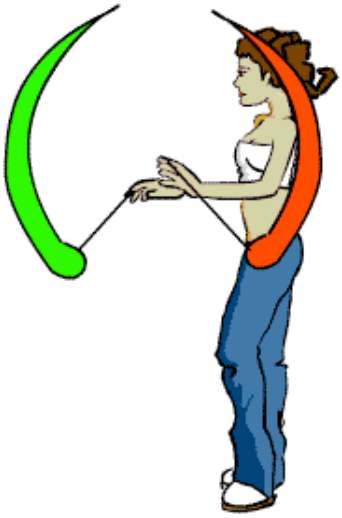


Ok. The best place to start with this move is by spinning some outward butterfly.

2.

Turn 90º right as the poi are coming up. Make sure you move your right poi as you turn so that it lands by your side...

3.



...You should now be spinning a forward circle on your right and a backward circle with your left poi.

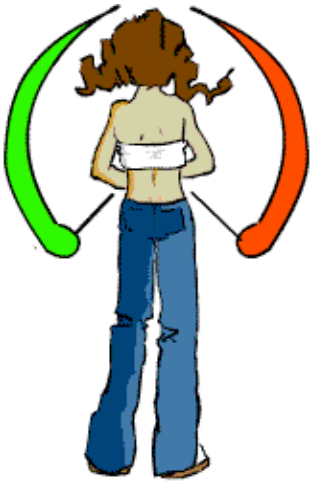
Turn over for stages 4 and 5…

Lesson 7
Basics: Butterfly Turn (page 2 of 2)

4.

As the poi come up, turn a further 90º. This time move your left hand round so that it lands above your right...

5.



...You should now be spinning inwards butterfly.

Now try turning starting with an inwards butterfly. The principle is the same but reversed ending with outward butterfly.

When you're comfortable going both ways you can try skipping the middle section so you turn the whole 180 in one beat of the poi without spinning the circles in the middle.